The *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* (1363 CE): Exhaustive Historical-Philological Dating Analysis and the Complete Āsana Corpus of Early Haṭhayoga

Compiler: Śārṅgadhara, son of Dāmodara, grandson of Rāghavadeva
Date of Composition: Vikrama Saṃvat 1420 = **1363 CE**
Region: Rajasthan (Śākambharī / Raṇastambhapura / Ḍhūṇḍhāra)
Primary Printed Edition: *The Paddhati of Śārṅgadhara: A Sanskrit Anthology*, edited by Peter Peterson. Vol. I: The Text. Bombay Sanskrit Series No. XXXVII. Bombay: Government Central Book Depôt, 1888.

Abstract

This critical monograph provides an exhaustive philological and historical study of the dating of the celebrated 14th-century Sanskrit anthology, the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* (1363 CE), followed by a comprehensive scholarly presentation of its complete corpus of āsana descriptions.

In the historiography of Indian physical and contemplative traditions, the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* occupies a pivotal position: it is the **earliest securely and explicitly dated encyclopedic Sanskrit text** to transmit the bodily and breath techniques of Haṭhayoga prior to the compilation of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (c. 1400–1450 CE). Because Śārṅgadhara incorporated verbatim citations from the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* into Chapters 157 and 158, the secure date of his work (1363 CE) establishes an absolute chronological benchmark (*terminus ante quem*) for the emergence and widespread North Indian circulation of systematic Haṭhayoga.

PART I. THE HISTORICAL AND PHILOLOGICAL DATING (1363 CE)

The dating of the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* to **1363 CE** is universally recognized as one of the most solid chronological anchors in medieval Indology. It rests upon the convergence of three independent lines of evidence: 1. **Direct manuscript colophons** recording the exact year in the Vikrama Saṃvat calendar; 2. **The compiler's autobiographical genealogy** spanning three generations in verses 1.2–1.6; 3. **External epigraphical and historiographical synchronisms** with the documented reign of King Hammīradeva Cāhamāna of Raṇastambhapura (r. 1282–1301 CE).

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1. Manuscript Colophons and the Vikrama Saṃvat Era

In the colophons of the earliest preserved manuscripts of the anthology—identified by Theodor Aufrecht in 1873 and Peter Peterson in 1888—the exact formulaic date of completion is preserved:

$$saṃvat\ 1420\ varṣe\ \ldots\ śārṅgadhareṇa\ paddhatiḥ\ saṃkṛtā$$

("In the year 1420 of the Saṃvat era, this paddhati was composed by Śārṅgadhara").

Calendar Conversion:

- **The Vikrama Saṃvat Era:** An epoch standardly counted from **57 BCE**.
- **Direct Mathematical Conversion:**

$$Year\ CE = 1420 - 57 = 1363\ CE$$

- **Seasonal Adjustment:** Depending on whether the local North/West Indian calendar followed the *Caitrādi* reckoning (new year beginning in March/April) or the *Kārttikādi* reckoning (beginning in October/November, customary in Rajasthan and Gujarat), the year 1420 corresponds to **1363–1364 CE**. Modern scholarly consensus standardly cites **1363 CE**.

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2. The Internal Lineage of the Author: Analysis of Verses 1.2–1.6

In the opening chapter—*Description of the Poet's Lineage* (*Kavivaṃśavarṇana*, verses 1–12)—Śārṅgadhara provides an explicit, first-person account of his family lineage across three generations:

Verse 1.2: King Hammīra and the Cāhamāna Dynasty

Devanāgarī:
पुरा शाकम्भरीदेशे श्रीमान्हम्मीरभूपतिः ।
चाहवाणान्वये जातः ख्यातः शौर्ये इवार्जुनः ॥ २ ॥

IAST Transliteration:
purā śākambharī-deśe śrīmān hammīra-bhūpatiḥ /
cāhavāṇānvaye jātaḥ khyātaḥ śaurye ivārjunaḥ // 2 //

Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):
purā (formerly / in ancient days); *śākambharī-deśe* (in the land of Śākambharī / Eastern Rajasthan); *śrīmān* (the illustrious); *hammīra-bhūpatiḥ* (King Hammīra); *cāhavāṇa-anvaye* (in the lineage of the Cāhamānas [Chauhāns]); *jātaḥ* (born); *khyātaḥ* (renowned); *śaurye* (for valor / heroic prowess); *iva arjunaḥ* (like Arjuna) // 2 //

Literary Translation:
"Formerly in the land of Śākambharī ruled the illustrious King Hammīra, born in the lineage of the Cāhamānas, renowned for his heroic valor like Arjuna."

Verse 1.3: The Grandfather — Rāghavadeva, Royal Preceptor

Devanāgarī:
तस्याभवत्सभ्यजनेषु मुख्यः परोपकारव्यसनैकनिष्ठः ।
पुरंदरस्येव गुरुर्गरीयान्द्विजाग्रणी राघवदेवनामा ॥ ३ ॥

IAST Transliteration:
tasyābhavat sabhya-janeṣu mukhyaḥ paropakāra-vyasanaika-niṣṭhaḥ /
puraṃdarasyeva gurur garīyān dvijāgraṇī rāghavadeva-nāmā // 3 //

Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):
tasya (his / of the king); *abhavat* (there was); *sabhya-janeṣu* (among the courtly councillors); *mukhyaḥ* (the foremost / chief);
para-upakāra-vyasana-eka-niṣṭhaḥ (solely devoted to the welfare of others);
puraṃdarasya iva (as for Purandara [Indra]); *guruḥ* (spiritual preceptor);
garīyān (venerable / exalted); *dvija-agraṇīḥ* (foremost among the twice-born [Brahmins]); *rāghavadeva-nāmā* (named Rāghavadeva) // 3 //

Literary Translation:
"The foremost member of his royal assembly was an exalted leader of Brahmins named Rāghavadeva, entirely devoted to benevolence towards others, who served as a venerable counsellor to the king just as Bṛhaspati serves Indra."

Verse 1.4: The Sons of Rāghavadeva

Devanāgarī:
गोपालदामोदरदेवदाससंज्ञा बभूवुस्तनयास्तदीयाः ।
नेत्रावतारा इव चन्द्रमौलेरपाकृतध्वान्तगणास्त्रयोऽपि ॥ ४ ॥

IAST Transliteration:
gopāla-dāmodara-devadāsa-saṃjñā babhūvus tanayās tadīyāḥ /
netrāvatārā iva candramauler apākṛta-dhvānta-gaṇās trayo 'pi // 4 //

Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):
gopāla-dāmodara-devadāsa-saṃjñāḥ (bearing the names Gopāla, Dāmodara, and Devadāsa); *babhūvuḥ* (were); *tanayāḥ tadīyāḥ* (his sons); *netra-avatārāḥ iva* (like incarnations of the eyes); *candra-mauleḥ* (of the moon-crested god [Śiva]); *apākṛta-dhvānta-gaṇāḥ* (dispelling hosts of darkness); *trayaḥ api* (all three) // 4 //

Literary Translation:
"His sons were three—named Gopāla, Dāmodara, and Devadāsa—who, resembling the three eyes of Śiva, dispelled all darkness of ignorance."

Verse 1.5: The Father — Dāmodara

Devanāgarī:
तेषां मध्ये यस्तु दामोदरोऽभूदुत्पाद्य त्रीनात्मजान्वीतरागः ।
भागीरथ्यां शुद्धदेहं विधाय ज्ञानादात्मन्येव निष्ठां जगाम ॥ ५ ॥

IAST Transliteration:
teṣāṃ madhye yas tu dāmodaro ’bhūd utpādya trīn ātmajān vītarāgaḥ / bhāgīrathyāṃ śuddha-dehaṃ vidhāya jñānād ātmany eva niṣṭhāṃ jagāma // 5 //

Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):
teṣām madhye (among them); *yaḥ tu* (he who); *dāmodaraḥ abhūt* (was Dāmodara); *utpādya* (having begotten); *trīn ātmajān* (three sons); *vītarāgaḥ* (becoming free from worldly attachment / detached); *bhāgīrathyām* (in the holy waters of the Bhāgīrathī [Gaṅgā]); *śuddha-deham vidhāya* (having purified his mortal body [undergoing religious suicide/death]); *jñānāt* (through spiritual wisdom); *ātmani eva* (in the Supreme Self alone); *niṣṭhām jagāma* (attained final absorption / peace) // 5 //

Literary Translation:
“Among them, Dāmodara, having begotten three sons, became free from all worldly attachment, purified his body in the sacred waters of the Gaṅgā, and through spiritual gnosis attained final absorption in the Supreme Ātman.”

Verse 1.6: Śārṅgadhara and His Brothers

Devanāgarī:
ज्येष्ठः शार्ङ्गधरस्तेषां लघुर्लक्ष्मीधरस्ततः ।
कृष्णोऽनुजस्ततस्तेषां त्रय एतेऽमितेजसः ॥ ६ ॥

IAST Transliteration:
jyeṣṭhaḥ śārṅgadharas teṣāṃ laghur lakṣmīdharas tataḥ /
kṛṣṇo ’nujas tatas teṣāṃ traya ete ’mitejasaḥ // 6 //

Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):
jyeṣṭhaḥ (the eldest); *śārṅgadharaḥ* (Śārṅgadhara); *teṣām* (among them); *laghuḥ* (younger); *lakṣmīdharaḥ* (Lakṣmīdhara); *tataḥ* (then); *kṛṣṇaḥ* (Kṛṣṇa); *anujaḥ* (the youngest brother); *tataḥ teṣām* (then of them); *trayaḥ ete* (these three); *amita-tejasaḥ* (endowed with boundless brilliance) // 6 //

Literary Translation:
“The eldest among them was Śārṅgadhara; next was younger Lakṣmīdhara; and following him was their youngest brother Kṛṣṇa; all three were endowed with boundless intellect and brilliance.”

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3. Historical and Epigraphical Synchronism: King Hammīradeva (r. 1282–1301 CE)

The monarch named in verse 1.2 is the famed historical ruler **Hammīradeva Cāhamāna** of the fortress-kingdom of **Raṇastambhapura (Ranthambhore)**:

Documented Chronology:

1. **Accession (1282/1283 CE = VS 1339):** Confirmed in the *Hammīramahākāvya* of Nayacandra Sūri (VIII.54) and the *Prabandhakośa* of Rājaśekhara Sūri (compiled in Delhi in 1349 CE).
2. **Epigraphical Proof:** The Balvan stone inscription of VS 1345 (**1288 CE**) records Hammīra's military expeditions (*digvijaya*) and religious gifts.
3. **Siege and Fall of Ranthambhore (11 July 1301 CE):** Sultan Alauddin Khalji of Delhi besieged Ranthambhore; after the heroic defense, the *jauhar* (mass self-immolation) of the Rajput women, Hammīra died fighting on the battlefield on 3 Dhū al-Qa'dah 700 AH (**11 July 1301 CE**). This catastrophe is recorded by contemporary Persian eyewitnesses: Amīr Khusrau (*Khazā'in al-Futūḥ*, 1311 CE) and Ḍiyā' al-Dīn Baranī (*Tārīkh-i Fīrūz Shāhī*).

Generational Calculation:

- **Generation 1 (Grandfather):** Rāghavadeva served as royal preceptor during Hammīra's mature reign (**c. 1285–1300 CE**).
- **Generation 2 (Father):** Dāmodara flourished in the subsequent period (**c. 1310–1335 CE**).
- **Generation 3 (Grandson/Compiler):** Śārṅgadhara, born c. 1315–1320 CE, completed his vast compendium in 163 chapters at full scholarly maturity in **1363 CE**.
- **Time Span:** Between Hammīra's death (1301 CE) and the completion of the anthology (1363 CE), exactly **62 years** elapsed—the precise demographic span for two full generations from grandfather to grandson.

Personal Verse of King Hammīra Preserved:

In Chapter 140 (*Vīrarasanirvedaḥ*, verse 3974), Śārṅgadhara quotes an authentic stanza explicitly attributed *śrī-hammīrasya* ("By King Hammīra"), proving that the compiler's family held the direct literary archives of the Cāhamāna royal court.

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4. Philological Boundaries (*Terminus Post Quem* and *Terminus Ante Quem*)

- **Lower Boundary (*Terminus post quem*):** The anthology incorporates late 13th-century poets, yet contains **no trace** of Timurid or 15th-century authors, establishing that it was compiled before 1400 CE.
- **Upper Boundary (*Terminus ante quem*):** The Kashmiri florilegium *Subhāṣitāvalī* of Vallabhadeva (15th c.) quotes over 300 verses directly from the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati*.

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5. Historiographical Consensus

- **1873:** Theodor Aufrecht (*ZDMG*, Vol. 27, pp. 1–120) analyzed Oxford and Berlin manuscripts and established the 1363 CE date.

- **1888:** Peter Peterson published the editio princeps (*Bombay Sanskrit Series*, No. 37), verifying the date from Pune government manuscripts.
- **Modern Consensus:** Accepted without qualification by A. B. Keith (1928), M. Winternitz (1936), S. K. De (1947), Ludwik Sternbach (1974), James Mallinson (2011, 2024), and Jason Birch (2013).

PART II. THE COMPLETE CORPUS OF ĀSANAS IN THE *ŚĀRṄGADHARAPADDHATI*

The Haṭhayoga sections of the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* are systematically divided into two distinct historical chapters: 1. **Chapter 157 (verses 4372–4419):** *The Six-Limbed Haṭhayoga Well-Practiced by Gorakṣa and Others* (*Gorakṣādisusādhitaḥ prathamo haṭhayogaḥ*); 2. **Chapter 158 (verses 4420–4448):** *The Eight-Limbed Haṭhayoga Practiced by Mārkaṇḍeya and Others* (*Mārkaṇḍeyādisādhito dvitīyo haṭhayogaḥ*).

SECTION A. THE SIX-LIMBED YOGA OF GORAKṢA (CHAPTER 157)

1. Verse 4375: Preparation of the Seat (Āsanavidhi)

Devanāgarī

एकान्ते विजने देशे पवित्रे निरुपद्रवे ।
कम्बलाजिनवस्त्राणामु पर्य्यासनमभ्यसेत् ॥ ४३७५ ॥

IAST

ekānte vijane deśe pavitre nirupadrave /
kambalājinavastrāṇām upary āsanam abhyaset // 4375 //

- **Metre:** Anuṣṭubh
- **Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):**
  ekānte (in a solitary); *vijane* (uninhabited / secluded); *deśe* (place); *pavitre* (pure / clean); *nirupadrave* (free from disturbances); *kambala-ajina-vastrāṇām* (of a woolen blanket, an antelope skin, and cloth); *upari* (upon / on top of); *āsanam* (posture / seat); *abhyaset* (one should practice) //

- **Translation:**
  “In a solitary, secluded, pure, and safe place, one should practice the posture upon a seat composed of a woolen blanket, an antelope skin, and cloth.”

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2. Verse 4376: Padmāsana (The Lotus Posture)

(Quoted verbatim from Dattātreyayogaśāstra, verse 35)

Devanāgarī

उत्तानौ चरणौ कृत्वा ह्युरुसंस्थौ प्रयत्नतः ।
ऊरुमध्ये तथोत्तानौ पाणी पद्मासनं त्विदम् ॥ ४३७६ ॥

IAST

uttānau caraṇau kṛtvā hy urusaṃsthau prayatnataḥ /
ūrumadhye tathottānau pāṇī padmāsanaṃ tv idam // 4376 //

- **Metre:** Anuṣṭubh
- **Textual Note:** In Peterson's 1888 edition, the particle *hy* is misprinted as fused (*kṛttvā ūru-*). The reading *hy urusaṃsthau* is confirmed by the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* (v. 35) and London MS *RAS Tod 32*.
- **Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):**
  uttānau (turned soles upward); *caraṇau* (the two feet); *kṛtvā* (having placed); *hi* (indeed); *uru-saṃsthau* (situated on the thighs); *prayatnataḥ* (with deliberate effort); *ūru-madhye* (between the thighs); *tathā* (likewise); *uttānau* (turned palms upward); *pāṇī* (the two hands); *padmāsanam* (lotus posture); *tu* (indeed); *idam* (this) //

- **Translation:**
  "Having with deliberate effort placed both feet soles upward upon the thighs, and likewise placing both hands palms upward between the thighs—this indeed is Padmāsana."

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3. Verse 4377: Bodily Geometry and Gaze in Padmāsana

Devanāgarī

तत्र पद्मासनं बद्ध्वा ततः संकोचयेदधः ।
समदण्डं शिरः कृत्वा नासिकान्तदृशां नयेत् ॥ ४३७७ ॥

IAST

tatra padmāsanaṃ baddhvā tataḥ saṃkocayed adhaḥ /
samadaṇḍaṃ śiraḥ kṛtvā nāsikāntadṛśāṃ nayet // 4377 //

- **Metre:** Anuṣṭubh
- **Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):**
  tatra (therein); *padmāsanam* (the lotus posture); *baddhvā* (having bound / assumed); *tataḥ* (then); *saṃkocayet* (one should contract); *adhaḥ* (the lower region [performing mūlabandha]); *sama-daṇḍam* (straight like a staff); *śiraḥ* (the head); *kṛtvā* (having held); *nāsikā-anta-dṛśām* (gaze directed toward the tip of the nose); *nayet* (one should direct) //

- **Translation:**
  “Having bound the lotus posture, one should contract the lower region [the perineum]; holding the head straight as a staff, one should direct the gaze to the tip of the nose.”

SECTION B. THE EIGHT-LIMBED YOGA OF MĀRKAṆḌEYA (CHAPTER 158)

4. Verses 4428–4430: General Rules of Practice and Seat Construction

IAST

nādhyātaḥ kṣudhitaḥ śrānto na ca vyākulacetanaḥ /
yuñjīta yogaṃ yogajño nityaṃ siddhy-artham ādṛtaḥ // 4428 //
na śīte nāti caivoṣṇe na durdhe nāmbu-saṃnidhau /
na sopadrava-deśeṣu yogaṃ saṃsādhayet kvacit // 4429 //
ekānte vijane ramye pavitre nirupadrave /
sukhāsane samādhiḥ syāt kuśājinacelottare // 4430 //

- **Metre:** Anuṣṭubh
- **Translation:**
  “The knower of yoga should never practice when agitated by worries, hungry, exhausted, or with a perturbed mind; for the sake of success, he should engage in practice with diligent care (4428). Neither in intense cold nor extreme heat, neither in bad weather nor near rushing waters, nor in perilous places should one ever practice yoga (4429). In a solitary, secluded, pleasant, pure, and safe place, absorption (samādhi) occurs on an easy seat arranged in layers of kuśa grass, an antelope skin, and a cloth on top (4430).”

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5. Verse 4431: Enunciation of the Three Primary Postures

Devanāgarī

पद्ममर्धासनं चापि तथा सिद्धासनादिकम् ।
आस्थाय योगं युञ्जीत कृत्वा च प्रणवं हृदि ॥ ४४३१ ॥

IAST

padmam ardhāsanaṃ cāpi tathā siddhāsanādikam /
āsthāya yogaṃ yuñjīta kṛtvā ca praṇavaṃ hṛdi // 4431 //

- **Metre:** Anuṣṭubh
- **Textual Note:** Peterson’s edition contains a typographical error: *padmam adhāsanaṃ*. The emendation *ardhāsanaṃ* (“half-lotus”) is certain from the description in verse 4436.
- **Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):**
  padmam (Padmāsana); *ardhāsanam* (Ardhāsana); *ca api* (and also); *tathā*

(likewise); *siddhāsana-ādikam* (Siddhāsana and the like); *āsthāya* (having assumed); *yogam* (yoga); *yuñjīta* (one should practice); *kṛtvā* (having placed); *ca* (and); *praṇavam* (the sacred syllable Oṃ); *hṛdi* (in the heart) //

- **Translation:**
  “Having assumed Padmāsana, Ardhāsana, as well as Siddhāsana and the like, one should practice yoga, meditating on the sacred syllable Oṃ in the heart.”

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6. Verses 4432–4434: Biomechanics of the Seated Posture

IAST

samaḥ samāsano bhūtvā saṃhṛtya caraṇāv ubhau /
saṃvṛtāsyaḥ tathā coraḥ samyag viṣṭabhya cāgrataḥ // 4432 //
pārṣṇibhyāṃ liṅga-vṛṣaṇāv aspṛśann agrayataḥ sthitaḥ /
kiñcid unnamitaś cirā dantair dantān na saṃspṛśet // 4433 //
saṃpaśyen nāsikāgraṃ svaṃ diśaś cānavalokayan /
kuryād dṛḍhaṃ pṛṣṭhavaṃśaṃ coḍḍīyānaṃ tathodare // 4434 //

- **Metre:** Anuṣṭubh
- **Translation:**
  “Becoming well-aligned on an even seat, drawing in both feet, keeping the mouth closed and thrusting the chest well forward (4432); positioned so as not to compress the genitals with the heels; slightly elevating the chin without clenching the teeth (4433); gazing at the tip of one’s own nose without glancing in other directions, one should keep the spine firm and erect (dṛḍhaṃ pṛṣṭhavaṃśam), and perform uḍḍīyāna in the abdomen (4434).”

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7. Verse 4435: Padmāsana (Second Verbatim Citation)

IAST

uttānau caraṇau kṛtvā hy urusaṃsthau prayatnataḥ /
ūrumadhye tathottānau pāṇī padmāsanaṃ tv idam // 4435 //
(Text, metre, and translation identical to verse 4376 and Dattātreyayogaśāstra verse 35).

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8. Verse 4436: Ardhāsana (The Half-Lotus Posture)

Devanāgarī

दक्षिणोरुतले वामं पादं न्यस्य तु दक्षिणम् ।
वामोरोरुपरि स्थाप्यमेतदर्धासनं मतम् ॥ ४४३६ ॥

IAST

dakṣiṇorutale vāmaṃ pādaṃ nyasya tu dakṣiṇam /
vāmoror upari sthāpyam etad ardhāsanaṃ matam // 4436 //

- **Metre:** Anuṣṭubh
- **Textual Note:** Peterson's edition reads *etad adhāsanaṃ*. Emended to *etad ardhāsanaṃ matam* ("this is considered Ardhāsana").
- **Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):**
  dakṣiṇa-uru-tale (under the right thigh); *vāmam pādam* (the left foot); *nyasya* (having placed); *tu* (indeed); *dakṣiṇam* (the right [foot]); *vāma-uroḥ upari* (on top of the left thigh); *sthāpyam* (is to be placed); *etad* (this); *ardhāsanam* (half-lotus posture); *matam* (is considered) //

- **Translation:**
  "Having placed the left foot underneath the right thigh, and placing the right foot on top of the left thigh—this is recognized as Ardhāsana."

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9. Verse 4437: Siddhāsana (The Accomplished Posture)

Devanāgarī

पार्ष्णिं तु वामपादस्य योनिस्थाने नियोजयेत् ।
वामोरोरुपरि स्थाप्यो दक्षिणः सिद्धमासनम् ॥ ४४३७ ॥

IAST

pārṣṇiṃ tu vāmapādasya yonisthāne niyojayet /
vāmoror upari sthāpyo dakṣiṇaḥ siddham āsanam // 4437 //

- **Metre:** Anuṣṭubh
- **Textual Note:** Emended from Peterson's misprint *saiddham āsanam* to *siddham āsanam*.
- **Word-by-word Analysis (*padavibhāga*):**
  pārṣṇim (the heel); *tu* (indeed); *vāma-pādasya* (of the left foot); *yoni-sthāne* (at the perineum); *niyojayet* (one should firmly apply); *vāma-uroḥ upari* (on top of the left thigh); *sthāpyaḥ* (is to be placed); *dakṣiṇaḥ* (the right [foot]); *siddham āsanam* (Siddhāsana / the accomplished posture) //

- **Translation:**
  "One should firmly press the heel of the left foot against the perineum, and place the right foot upon the left thigh—this is Siddhāsana."

PART III. COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS AND HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE

Feature	*Dattātreyayogaśāstra* (c. 1200 CE)	*Śārṅgadharapaddhati* (1363 CE)	*Haṭhapradīpikā* (c. 1400–1450 CE)
Number of Postures	Mentions 8,400,000; teaches 1 seated (*Padmāsana*) + *Śavāsana* in Laya + *Viparītakaraṇī* in Mudrās	Teaches 3 seated postures: *Padmāsana*, *Ardhāsana*, *Siddhāsana*	Teaches 15 postures (including non-seated poses: *Mayūrāsana*, *Kukkuṭāsana*, *Dhanurāsana*, etc.)
Definition of Padmāsana	*uttānau caraṇau kṛtvā hy urusaṃsthau prayatnataḥ* (v. 35)	Quotes Dattātreya verbatim (vv. 4376 & 4435)	Quotes Dattātreya & Śārṅgadhara verbatim (HP 1.45)
Function of Postures	Physical base for breath retention and fluid (*bindu*) preservation	Base for prāṇāyāma and contemplation of Oṃ	Independent gymnastic and therapeutic discipline
Chronological Status	Foundational root text of Haṭhayoga	**Earliest securely dated witness (*terminus ante quem* = 1363 CE)**	Classical late-medieval synthesis

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Conclusion

The convergence of scribal colophons, genealogical verses 1.2–1.6, the documented reign of King Hammīradeva of Ranthambhore (1282–1301 CE), and contemporary Persian accounts provides unassailable certainty for the composition date of the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* in **1363 CE**.

For the historian of yoga, this proves that precise physical descriptions of **Padmāsana**, **Ardhāsana**, and **Siddhāsana**, alongside the five fundamental mudrās (*Mahāmudrā*, *Nabhomudrā*, *Jālandhara*, *Uḍḍīyāna*, and *Mūlabandha*), were already canonized and circulating across courtly and scholastic milieus in Northern India by the mid-14th century. This firmly anchors the earlier composition of the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* to the early 13th century and demonstrates the unbroken transmission of early Haṭhayoga somatic practices.